WEEK 4 ASSIGNMENT

AI FOR FUTURE WORKFORCE

VISUAL ODYSSEY

A Five-Image Storytelling Journey

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AI topic	Text-to-Image and Image-to-Image Generation
Story	The Ancient City of Eldoria



1. Introduction

Generative AI image models can create visual content from written descriptions. Text-to-image generation converts a prompt into a new image, while image-to-image generation uses an existing image as a visual reference and transforms or refines it according to a new prompt.

This assignment, titled **Visual Odyssey**, develops a connected story through five images. The narrative follows an archaeologist who discovers an ancient scroll, leads an expedition into the desert, encounters the spectral image of a lost city, uncovers its ruins and relics, and finally shares the discovery through a modern exhibition.

The five images are designed as sequential chapters. A consistent lead character, visual style, colour palette and setting help connect the images into one narrative.

2. Objectives

- To create a compelling visual narrative using a sequence of four to five AI-generated images.
- To practise writing clear and detailed text-to-image prompts.
- To understand how image-to-image generation can help preserve visual continuity.
- To maintain consistent characters, environments, mood and artistic style across the sequence.
- To document the creative process and evaluate the images against the assignment criteria.

3. Story Development

Title: The Ancient City of Eldoria

Genre: Historical adventure, mystery and fantasy

Central idea: An archaeologist discovers an ancient scroll that reveals the location of Eldoria, a forgotten city buried beneath the desert. Her expedition uncovers the city's remains and brings its history to the modern world.

Main character and visual continuity

Dr. Maya: A seasoned archaeologist in her early thirties, with dark wavy hair tied back, an olive-brown field jacket, a beige shirt, dark field trousers, a brown backpack and practical desert boots. Her appearance and clothing are kept consistent in all expedition scenes.

Supporting team: A small, diverse group of archaeologists and historians wearing practical desert expedition clothing.

Visual style: Cinematic realism, detailed environments, warm golden desert light, rich sandstone colours, atmospheric depth and a consistent adventurous mood.

4. Five-Image Visual Narrative

Each image represents one stage of the story. The sequence moves from discovery, to exploration, to revelation, to excavation and finally to public presentation.

Image 1 – The Mysterious Scroll

In a long-forgotten library, Dr. Maya discovers an ancient scroll covered with cryptic symbols. A drawing on the scroll appears to show a city hidden beneath the desert sands. This discovery gives her the clue needed to begin the expedition.

Contribution to the narrative: This opening image introduces the protagonist, the ancient artefact and the central mystery.



Image 2 – The Desert Expedition

Guided by the scroll, Dr. Maya leads a diverse team of experts into a vast desert. After days of travel through dunes and harsh conditions, the team approaches the location marked on the ancient map.

Contribution to the narrative: This image continues directly from the first: the scroll becomes the guide for the team's journey.



Image 3 – The Spectral Vision of Eldoria

As a sandstorm begins to clear, the team sees the spectral silhouette of Eldoria in the distance. Towers, domes and ancient walls emerge through the desert haze, appearing almost like a vision from another time.

Contribution to the narrative: This is the visual turning point. It reveals the lost city and builds suspense before the discovery.



Image 4 – The Forgotten Legacy

The team reaches the ruins and begins a careful excavation. Dr. Maya uncovers carved stonework, pottery and a beautifully preserved relic, revealing evidence of a sophisticated forgotten civilisation.

Contribution to the narrative: This image fulfils the expedition's purpose and turns the mysterious vision into a tangible archaeological discovery.



Image 5 – A Legacy for the World

Back in the present day, the discoveries are displayed in a modern museum exhibition. Visitors gather around the artefacts as Dr. Maya's research introduces the history of Eldoria to the world.

Contribution to the narrative: The final image resolves the story by connecting the ancient past with the present and showing the wider importance of the discovery.


5. A Legacy for the World
THE ANCIENT CITY OF ELDORIA
In a stunning modern exhibit, the legacy of Eldoria is finally shared with the world, connecting the ancient past with the present.

5. Prompt Engineering

The prompts below are designed for Stable Diffusion XL (SDXL) text-to-image generation. They specify the subject, action, setting, lighting, mood, composition and visual style. The same character description and style terms are repeated to support consistency.

Prompt 1 – Library discovery

A seasoned female archaeologist discovers an ancient parchment scroll in a long-forgotten historical library, towering wooden bookshelves, dust floating in a beam of golden window light, mysterious cryptic symbols and a hand-drawn map of a lost desert city visible on the scroll, medium cinematic composition, detailed historical atmosphere. Recurring character reference: Dr. Maya, a seasoned female archaeologist in her early thirties, dark wavy hair tied back, olive-brown field jacket, beige shirt, dark field trousers, brown backpack and practical desert boots. Cinematic realistic style, detailed textures, warm earthy colour palette, natural proportions, coherent lighting.

Prompt 2 – Expedition across the desert

The same archaeologist leads a diverse team of four researchers across a vast golden desert toward distant sandstone mountains, footprints crossing wind-swept dunes, expedition backpacks and field equipment, the team seen moving toward the horizon, wide cinematic establishing shot, bright late-afternoon sunlight. Recurring character reference: Dr. Maya, a seasoned female archaeologist in her early thirties, dark wavy hair tied back, olive-brown field jacket, beige shirt, dark field trousers, brown backpack and practical desert boots. Cinematic realistic style, detailed textures, warm earthy colour palette, natural proportions, coherent lighting.

Prompt 3 – Spectral city revealed

The same archaeologist and expedition team stand on a desert ridge as a colossal ancient city appears through swirling sand and mirage-like haze, sandstone towers, domes and monumental gates glowing in the distance, dramatic atmospheric perspective, awe and mystery, wide cinematic shot. Recurring character reference: Dr. Maya, a seasoned female archaeologist in her early thirties, dark wavy hair tied back, olive-brown field jacket, beige shirt, dark field trousers, brown backpack and practical desert boots. Cinematic realistic style, detailed textures, warm earthy colour palette, natural proportions, coherent lighting.

Prompt 4 – Excavation and relic discovery

The same archaeologist kneels carefully at an excavation site among the sandstone ruins of the lost city, uncovering an ornate ancient golden medallion and carved pottery fragments, other researchers document the site, detailed stone columns and weathered inscriptions, warm low-angle sunlight, cinematic archaeological realism. Recurring character reference: Dr. Maya, a seasoned female archaeologist in her early thirties, dark wavy hair tied back, olive-brown field jacket, beige shirt, dark field trousers, brown backpack and practical desert boots. Cinematic realistic style, detailed textures, warm earthy colour palette, natural proportions, coherent lighting.

Prompt 5 – Museum exhibition

A grand contemporary museum exhibition dedicated to the ancient city of Eldoria, the recovered golden medallion and pottery displayed in a glass case, visitors observing the artefacts, the same archaeologist Dr. Maya standing nearby presenting the discovery, elegant modern gallery architecture, warm focused exhibition lighting, cinematic realistic photography.

Suggested negative prompt

blurry, low resolution, distorted hands, extra fingers, duplicated people, deformed faces, inconsistent clothing, inconsistent character appearance, unreadable lettering, watermark, logo, oversaturated colours, cartoon style, low-detail background.

6. Text-to-Image and Image-to-Image Workflow

Text-to-image: Begin by generating the first image using the detailed prompt. For the remaining scenes, use the same character description, visual style and colour palette. If available, keep the model, aspect ratio and seed consistent to reduce variation.

Image-to-image: Use the best image of Dr. Maya as a visual reference for later scenes. Upload the reference image and describe the new action and environment while asking the model to preserve her face, hairstyle and clothing. Adjust the image strength or denoising setting so that the new scene can change without losing the reference character's identity.

Suggested model choices from the assignment brief: Stable Diffusion XL Base 1.0 for text-to-image generation and Stable Diffusion XL Refiner 1.0 for image-to-image refinement. The brief also lists DALL·E 3 on Bing Image Creator as a recommended alternative.

Practical note: The storyboard visuals included in this report are AI-generated illustrative samples. They are not represented as outputs from Stable Diffusion. To meet a requirement for verified Stable Diffusion outputs, regenerate the scenes with the specified Hugging Face models and replace these samples with the resulting images.

7. Thought Process and Design Decisions

- **Choosing the storyline:** The benchmark storyline in the assignment brief was selected because it naturally supports five connected visual stages.
- **Keeping the character consistent:** Dr. Maya's age range, hairstyle, jacket, shirt, trousers and backpack are repeated in the prompts.
- **Maintaining visual continuity:** The story uses a warm sandstone palette, cinematic realism and desert atmosphere across the expedition scenes.
- **Planning the sequence:** Each image has one clear purpose and leads logically to the next stage of the story.
- **Refining the prompts:** The prompts focus on the main subject, action, setting, lighting and composition instead of adding unrelated details.

8. Evaluation Against Assignment Criteria

Evaluation parameter	How the assignment addresses it
Narrative consistency	The five images follow one protagonist and a clear sequence from scroll discovery to museum exhibition.
Prompt precision	Each prompt identifies the subject, action, environment, mood, lighting and composition, with a repeated character reference.
Sequencing logic	The images progress in chronological order: clue, expedition, sighting, excavation and exhibition.
Adherence to storyline	The narrative follows the Eldoria benchmark storyline provided in the assignment presentation.
Visual quality	The visual direction aims for cinematic realism, detailed environments, warm lighting and a unified colour palette.

9. Challenges and Observations

Challenges

- Maintaining the same character identity across multiple generated images can be difficult because text-to-image models may change facial features, hairstyle or clothing.
- A prompt that contains too many unrelated details may confuse the model and weaken the composition.
- The desert city and its architecture need to look related across the images, even when the camera angle and scene change.
- Image-to-image settings must be balanced: too much influence from the reference can limit the new scene, while too little can reduce consistency.

Observations

- Specific prompts produce more controlled and relevant visual results than vague descriptions.
- Repeating a character reference and style description helps establish visual continuity.

- A clear storyboard makes it easier to identify what each image must communicate.
- Image-to-image generation can be useful for carrying a character or visual reference into a new scene.
- Human review is important to check whether the images tell the intended story in the correct order.

10. Conclusion

The Visual Odyssey assignment demonstrates how Generative AI can be used to develop a visual story through text-to-image and image-to-image techniques. The five scenes present a connected journey: Dr. Maya discovers an ancient scroll, leads an expedition, encounters the spectral city of Eldoria, uncovers its relics and finally shares the discovery with the world.

The exercise highlights the importance of prompt engineering, consistent character descriptions, logical sequencing and visual review. It also shows that AI image generation is an iterative process: the creator must guide the model, evaluate the results and refine prompts or reference images to achieve a coherent visual narrative.

End of Assignment